

Planning for the future is not only essential for your motivation and drive, but it's also really important for those key elements of financial wellbeing that we discussed earlier in the book: security and freedom. It doesn't really matter whether you're the kind of person who likes to plan things to the letter, or whether you like to go with the flow, looking after your financial future and ensuring that your resources are fairly distributed between your present self and your future self will only ever improve your relationship with money. It will help you to navigate bumps in the road, and encourage you to feel positive about money, at least for the most part. The degree of detail to which you plan for your financial future is entirely up to you, of course, but taking steps to grow something for the life that you want to lead will only ever be a positive thing.

When I was struggling with my relationship with money, my ideas about the future of my financial situation were not rooted in reality at all – pretty much every idea I had about the life I'd like to live was dependent on some kind of extreme change in fortune, rather than on me sowing the seeds of a prosperous future in the present and watching them grow. Then, when I started to work on my financial wellbeing and take steps to repay the money that I owed, for a long time I felt like I was too busy filling in holes and correcting mistakes from the past to even think about the future. When I finally began to see the light at the end of that tunnel, and when much of the other work I was doing on my financial wellbeing was underway and starting to produce results – namely, the themes we have